

and investing \$184,000 (\$6,000 in 1973, \$46,000 in 1987, \$68,000 in 2000, and \$64,000 in 2007), she had amassed \$1.16 million. This means she put \$184,000 into the market and profited \$980,000. Because Lauren was in the market for so long (over 35 years), she still averaged about an 8% return despite having some years where she lost as much as 48% in a single year.

When you are thinking about investing, especially if you start young, do not ask, "Is this a good time to put my money into the market?" Remember, time in the market is better than timing the market. If you know you are going to be investing in the long term, the best time to invest in the market is right now. The longer you are invested, the more money you will likely make.